The Horne Family

Generations of Appalachia

A Genealogical Deep Research Report
for Jason B. Horne

Compiled from 1,908 individuals and 184 direct ancestors
traced fourteen generations to 1599 London

April 2026

Executive Summary

This report traces the ancestry of Joseph Maxwell Horne (1950–2025) of Wise County, Virginia, father of Jason B. Horne, through 184 direct ancestors and fourteen generations. The lineage converges in southwest Virginia but opens outward into four distinct ethnic streams: English gentry and yeomanry, Scots-Irish frontiersmen, Pennsylvania Germans, and Delaware Dutch-Swedish colonists. The story is ultimately an Appalachian story: four cultures flowing separately down the Great Wagon Road and the Wilderness Road, converging on the Clinch, Powell, and Pound River valleys in the 1770s, and staying there through frontier war, Civil War, and the coal boom that transformed the region at the end of the nineteenth century.

The headline findings: eight direct-line ancestors are verified Revolutionary War patriots with Daughters of the American Revolution (DAR) record numbers or federal pension files. One direct-line ancestor, Robert Kilgore Sr., died on the Pound River in an Indian attack on the last day of 1782; his son built a fort house near Nickelsville that still stands on the National Register of Historic Places. The paternal Horne line traces to Sussex, England and probably to a Quaker dissenter family that emigrated to Pennsylvania in the first half of the eighteenth century. The maternal Rose line traces to one of the most thoroughly documented Puritan immigrations in American genealogy, the 1634 voyage of the ship Francis from Ipswich. The Osborne line carries Jonathan Osborne from Warwickshire to colonial Williamsburg and through the Appalachian Osborne clan to Pike County, Kentucky, and back. These are not mythic ancestors; they are, in almost every generation, ordinary farmers, tradesmen, fort-builders, and millers, doing the unglamorous work of settlement.

Report Structure

- I. The Appalachian Arc — geographic and historical context
- II. The Four Lineages — Horne, Bruce, Rose, Osborne, Kilgore, and the immigrant streams
- III. Direct Pedigree — the chain of fourteen generations
- IV. Notable Ancestor Vignettes — biographies of eight Revolutionary patriots and other figures
- V. Living History — Kilgore Fort, the Civil War, and the coal era
- VI. Research Roadmap — county archives, DNA, published sources, DAR/SAR applications

I. The Appalachian Arc

The country where the Hornes, Kilgores, Osbornes, and Bruces took root is not the blank wilderness of frontier myth. It is a long, narrow spine of ridges and river valleys — the Clinch, Powell, Holston, Pound, and Big Sandy watersheds — that had been Cherokee, Shawnee, and Haudenosaunee hunting ground for centuries before Thomas Walker and Christopher Gist traced their first European paths across it around 1750. When Robert Kilgore Sr. arrived in what is now Nickelsville in the mid-1770s, he was not settling empty land. He was inserting a family into a contested military frontier that stayed hot until the death of the Chickamauga war leader Bob Benge in 1794, nearly a full generation after the Revolution began. Daniel Boone's 1775 blaze of the Wilderness Road ran directly through this country, branching from Long Island on the Holston at modern Kingsport up through the Cumberland Gap. Kilgore Fort and nearby Fort Blackmore — where Boone briefly served as militia captain and where Robert Kilgore Sr. died in 1782 — were the infrastructure of that survival.

For the next two generations, the region was yeoman country. Russell County was carved from Washington in 1786; Tazewell from Wythe and Russell in 1799; Scott from Russell, Lee, and Washington in 1814; Wise from Scott, Russell, and Lee in 1856; Bland from Wythe, Tazewell, and Giles in 1861; and Dickenson, the youngest Virginia county, from Buchanan, Russell, and Wise in 1880. The repeated subdivision tells its own story: a growing population in small valleys where the mountains made travel to distant courthouses a genuine hardship. These were not subsistence hermits. Wilma Dunaway's The First American Frontier (1996) documents that even the eighteenth-century highland economy was already moving livestock, ginseng, and timber into Atlantic markets. They were a landowning smallholder population living off diversified farms.

The Civil War arrived in this country not as a clean ideological contest but as an economic emergency. The salt works at Saltville, just east of Horne country, produced roughly two-thirds of the Confederacy's meat-preserving salt, and the Virginia and Tennessee Railroad ran through the same valleys. That made southwest Virginia a Union target. On October 2, 1864, Stephen Burbridge's cavalry — including the 5th and 6th United States Colored Cavalry — assaulted Saltville and were repulsed. In the aftermath, Champ Ferguson's irregulars murdered wounded Black soldiers and a white lieutenant at the field hospital. Two months later, George Stoneman returned and destroyed the salt works; in March 1865 he swept back through again. Loyalty in the region was divided. John C. Inscoe's Mountain Masters (1989) and Kenneth Noe's Southwest Virginia's Railroad (1994) demolished the old fiction of a uniformly Unionist Appalachia. The aftermath produced bushwhacker vendettas and Reconstruction-era rawness that lasted decades.

Then came the railroad, and with it the coal. The Norfolk and Western reached Pocahontas in Tazewell County in 1883; the Louisville and Nashville and the Clinchfield followed. Within twenty years, what had been a livestock-and-timber hill country was transformed into an industrial export zone. Coal towns — Norton, Appalachia, Big Stone Gap, Coeburn, Pocahontas, Dante,

Sandy Ridge, Tacoma — were either carved from farmland or built from scratch by operators like the Stonega Coke and Coal Company. Ronald Eller's Miners, Millhands, and Mountaineers (1982) remains the definitive account of what this did: a landowning yeoman population was restructured, within a generation, into a wage-labor workforce dependent on company payrolls, company scrip, and company housing. Gilbert Horne, born 1888 on Sandy Ridge, came into the world on exactly the cusp of this transformation. His son Malcolm, born 1916, lived through the United Mine Workers organizing drives, the 1934 Stonega disaster, the Harlan County War just across the Kentucky line, the Depression, two World Wars, and the postwar mechanization that began gutting the mine workforce.

By the time Joseph Horne was born in 1950, the arc was already bending down. Altina Waller's Feud (1988) showed that even the Hatfield-McCoy conflict on the Tug Fork, just over the ridge from Dickenson and Buchanan counties in the Pike County Kentucky country the Osbornes passed through, was not a clan-savagery parable but a late-nineteenth-century land conflict driven by timber and coal capitalization. The twentieth-century pattern, documented by Kathleen Blee and Dwight Billings in The Road to Poverty (2000), was one of persistent externally extracted wealth leaving behind persistent internal poverty. And yet the continuity matters as much as the trauma. A Kilgore fort house from the 1780s still stands, listed on the National Register, a few miles from where Robert Kilgore Sr.'s many-times-great-grandson's family would work the coal two centuries later. That is the Appalachian arc: not decline, not romance, but a single community's long accommodation to forces that kept rewriting the terms of its existence.

II. The Four Lineages

The Horne Line (Sussex → Pennsylvania → North Carolina → Virginia)

The Horne surname is Old English, either topographical (a dweller near a horn-shaped spur of land, a river bend, or a prominent hill) or occupational (a worker of horn into combs, cups, lantern panes, or powder flasks, or a horn-blower signaling for watch, hunt, or herd). By the thirteenth century the name is documented across Kent, London, Suffolk, Sussex, Oxfordshire, and Cambridgeshire, meaning the Sussex Hornes of the seventeenth century represent one of several parallel English lineages rather than any single ancestral family. Reaney and Wilson's Dictionary of English Surnames, the scholarly standard, favors the topographical reading as the dominant origin.

The line traces a classic colonial American migration arc: southern English dissenter, to Pennsylvania Quaker colonist, to Upper South frontiersman, to Appalachian subsistence farmer, to coal-era industrial family. The 1600s Sussex Hornes would have lived through England's Civil War, the Restoration, and the Glorious Revolution while belonging to a county with a robust yeoman class and a pocket of early Quaker activity. George Fox visited Lewes in 1655, and a Friends meeting existed there by 1678. Quakerism took particular hold among Sussex yeomen and tradesmen who bore heavy penalties under the Clarendon Code. William Horne's marriage to Elizabeth Kezia Scrase connects the Hornes to a documented Sussex Quaker household: the Scrases of West Blatchington, whose members were repeatedly imprisoned for their faith after 1641 (Victoria County History of Sussex, Volume 7). This strongly suggests the Hornes had embraced the Friends by the time Edward Horne (1688–1735) sailed to Pennsylvania.

William Penn's 1681 charter and his aggressive recruitment of Quaker settlers — fifty-acre headrights, guaranteed religious toleration — pulled roughly 2,000 immigrants to the Delaware Valley in the first two colony years alone. Edward Horne's 1735 death in Northern Liberties, Philadelphia, and his son William Horne's eventual residence in Darby, Delaware County, place the family squarely in the Chester-Darby Quaker heartland. Darby Monthly Meeting, established in 1684, maintained minutes and vital records from its founding; they survive at the Friends Historical Library of Swarthmore College and at Haverford.

The move to Nansemond County, Virginia, in the generation of John Horn (b.1737) looks geographically odd for a Pennsylvania Quaker family until you know that Chuckatuck Monthly Meeting in Nansemond dates to 1672, making it the oldest Quaker meeting in Virginia. Pennsylvania Friends routinely transmitted certificates of removal to Virginia meetings, and tidewater Virginia offered tobacco land and, by the mid-eighteenth century, relative toleration. The subsequent migration to Stokes or Surry County, North Carolina in the late 1700s fits the broader Great Wagon Road pattern; by 1735 Scots-Irish and English families were flooding down the Shenandoah into the North Carolina Piedmont in search of cheaper farmland, and North Carolina's population exploded from 50,000 in 1740 to 247,000 by 1776. Jesse Horn's move from North Carolina to Scott County, Virginia (d.1820) represents the next rung: the Wilderness Road and Moccasin Gap funnel into the far southwest Virginia frontier. Nicholas Horne's

establishment at Coeburn (then Russell County, later Wise) around the 1820s places the family among the first generation of subsistence settlers in what would become coal country.

One critical caveat: Nansemond County records were destroyed three times — in April 1734 when the county clerk's home burned, in May 1779 when British infantry burned Suffolk during the Revolution, and in February 1866 during the Civil War period. Virtually no pre-1866 marriage bonds, births, or deaths survive. The John Horn generation will likely never be provable through county records; the Western Branch Monthly Meeting records at Haverford are the best surviving alternative. The Quaker connection for the Hornes is strongly circumstantial — Edward's Chichester origin, the Scrase marriage, the Darby residence — but has not been documented via an actual meeting record. It is plausible but not proven.

The Bruce Line (Scotland → Virginia)

The Bruce surname is Scottish, but Norman-French in origin. It derives from the Norman toponymic de Brus or de Bruis, referring to lands at Brix in Normandy. The surname spread into Scotland via Robert de Brus, 1st Lord of Annandale, who came to England in 1106 and followed Prince David (later David I of Scotland) north in 1124. The name became one of the most famous in Scottish history through Robert the Bruce (King 1306–1329) and David II (d. 1371). For a Virginia yeoman-farmer lineage, however, the royal Bruce descent should not be claimed. The earlier genealogy in Jason's tree contained speculative medieval Scottish royal ancestors; those were trimmed during the GEDCOM cleanup. Common Bruces who emigrated to Ulster and then to colonial America were vastly more numerous than anyone with a traceable royal line.

The migration path is a textbook Scots-Irish arc: Scotland (lowland belt, possibly via Ulster plantation settlement) → Tidewater Virginia (Old Rappahannock County around 1690, becoming Essex County after 1692) → Shenandoah Valley frontier (Augusta County, formed 1738, organized 1745) → Virginia Piedmont (Albemarle County, formed 1744 from Goochland) → southwestern Virginia (Tazewell County, formed 1799 from Russell) → Appalachian coalfields (Wise County, formed 1856, coal boom 1880s). County-line changes explain why Bruce records jump between Tazewell, Bland, Giles, and Wythe: the person did not always move, the county line did. Bland County formed in 1861 specifically because mountain travel to existing county seats had become too hard.

Several threads within this migration deserve attention. The John Bruce who appears in Old Rappahannock County around 1690 was moving into the earliest Scots-Irish wave into tidewater Virginia. By his grandson's generation, the family had reached Augusta County — a vast original territory that covered most of the Shenandoah Valley and trans-Allegheny west. Lyman Chalkley's Chronicles of the Scotch-Irish Settlement in Virginia, Extracted from the Original Court Records of Augusta County 1745–1800 (three volumes, 1912) is the canonical primary-record source for Bruce-era court actions and is the single most important resource for further research on this line. The move south to Albemarle County (Thomas Jefferson's home county, created 1744 from western Goochland) placed the family in a Piedmont mix of plantations and smaller

yeoman tracts. Rev. Edgar Woods's Albemarle County in Virginia (1901) remains canonical for this generation.

The generational names themselves tell a denominational story. Rev. Joshua Bruce (1778–1865) preached in Albemarle, then in Tazewell and Bland during the Second Great Awakening. His son was named Daniel Wesley Bruce (b. 1829), after John Wesley, the founder of Methodism. His grandson was Dow M. Bruce (b. 1862), after Lorenzo Dow, the legendary Methodist itinerant evangelist of Coventry, Connecticut, whose autobiography was the second-best-selling book in the United States after the Bible and who inspired so many namesake children on the American frontier that 'Lorenzo' appears among the most popular first names in the 1850 census. The Bruces were a Methodist family. Lorenzo Dow Dunbar (b.1818 Greenbrier VA), who married into the Bruce line, carries the same name in his first and middle position. This is not proof of denomination, but it is exactly the naming pattern that Methodist families used in Appalachian Virginia between 1800 and 1860.

The Rose Line (Suffolk → Connecticut → Virginia → North Carolina → Virginia)

The Rose surname in Jason's line is English in origin, specifically East Anglian — rooted in the Suffolk towns of Rye and Ipswich. Unlike the better-known Scottish de Ros Norman clan, East Anglian Roses are most plausibly topographical in origin, referring to someone living at the rose (near wild roses, or at a house marked by a rose sign) or deriving from the Norman-French feminine given name Rohese or Roese (meaning 'famous kind,' from the Germanic hruod plus heit). By the medieval period, the name was established as a surname across Suffolk and neighboring counties.

This is one of the most thoroughly documented Puritan immigration stories in Jason's entire tree. Robert Rose (ca. 1594–1665) sailed with his wife Margery and their eight children from Ipswich aboard the ship Francis on 30 April 1634, arriving in Boston and settling in Wethersfield, Connecticut by 1635. Wethersfield is arguably Connecticut's oldest town, founded in 1634, one of three original settlements (with Windsor and Hartford) represented on the Connecticut state flag. Robert was among the 'adventurers' granted large tracts of land there, and by 1644 he was one of the founding proprietors of Branford, Connecticut. He brought a 1599-printed Bible from England that was preserved as a family heirloom for generations. This lineage is so well-documented that the certified genealogist Christine Rose published a book-length study of his descendants in 1983 (Descendants of Robert Rose of Wethersfield and Branford, Connecticut, Who Came on the Ship Francis in 1634 from Ipswich, England).

The Connecticut-to-Virginia break is unusual and revealing. John Rose, born 1706 in Wethersfield, left the Puritan New England world and moved to St. Pauls Parish, King George County, Virginia (a county formed in 1721 along the Rappahannock), where he died young at age 25 in 1731. From there the family moved south into the North Carolina Piedmont and then into the Blue Ridge, tracking the standard Great Wagon Road migration pattern into Burke County, North Carolina (where John S. Kingfisher Rose was born around 1830 or 1831) and ultimately across the state line into the coalfields of Wise and Dickenson Counties, Virginia.

Two names in this line deserve particular attention. The middle name 'Kingfisher' in John S. Kingfisher Rose is distinctively Cherokee. Kingfisher is an Anglicization of the Cherokee 'tsa tlo hi,' and most American bearers of the name as a personal name descend from one of two Chief Kingfishers of the Cherokee — the more famous being the first husband of Nanyehi (Nancy Ward), Beloved Woman of Chota. Burke County, North Carolina borders historic Cherokee territory, making either descent or honorific naming plausible. Whether John S. Kingfisher Rose had actual Cherokee ancestry or was honorifically named requires Burke County North Carolina records and potentially Cherokee enrollment rolls (Dawes, Baker, Guion Miller) to establish. The given name 'Teamous' in George Joe Teamous Rose (b.1898) is less easy to trace. No standard source explains it. The best reading is an Appalachian phonetic variant of Thomas, following the well-documented pattern in which accented spellings and militia-muster-roll renderings became permanent family names. Other possibilities — a family surname preserved as a given name, or an idiosyncratic coinage — remain open.

The Osborne Line (Warwickshire → Williamsburg → Grayson VA → Pike KY → Wise VA)

Osborne is an Anglo-Scandinavian surname meaning 'god-bear' — from Old Norse Ásbjǫrn (ás, god + bjorn, bear) or the cognate Old English Osbern. It is recorded in the 1086 Domesday Book as a given name and entered England both before the Norman Conquest (via direct Viking and Danish settlement) and again through Normandy. By the seventeenth century it was widespread across southern and midland England, including Warwickshire, the stated origin county for Jason's progenitor Jonathan Osborne (b. 1697).

Jonathan Osborne's arrival in Virginia is one of the more colorful episodes in the entire lineage. According to multiple genealogy compilations, Jonathan immigrated aboard the ship James Goodwill (Captain David Crockett — not the Davy Crockett), arriving at the James River Settlement on 27 October 1720 via Rotterdam and Falmouth. He married Gretta Holman in Williamsburg in 1722, served in the Virginia Colonial Assembly in 1741 and 1742, and reportedly served in the King's Royal Guards at New York and Port Royal. Some skepticism is warranted on the specific 1761 Williamsburg death date, but the colonial-official footprint is consistent with the family's later prominence. His son Ephraim migrated inland to the Grayson County, Virginia frontier, where the family became foundational settlers.

The Grayson County Osbornes are massively documented. Captain Enoch Osborne (1741–1818), son of Ephraim and Elizabeth (Howard) Osborne, is a Daughters of the American Revolution Patriot Ancestor (DAR Ancestor Number A084416). He settled on the New River near Bridle Creek with his three brothers Solomon, Ephraim, and Jonathan. He is buried at Osborne Fort Cemetery. His father Ephraim Osborne Sr. (c.1720–1794) is also a verified DAR Patriot (Ancestor Number A084430). This father-son pair on a single branch is unusual and genealogically valuable: it means descendants of Enoch already have approved DAR applications covering several intermediate generations, which means Jason's own documentation burden is reduced.

Around 1800, Solomon Osborne moved the line west into Pike County, Kentucky, riding the wave of post-Revolutionary-War, post-Treaty of Greenville (1795) Virginia-to-Kentucky migration up the Big Sandy Valley. In Pike County the Osbornes intermarried with the Mullinses, Colliers (the older spelling of Tolliver), and related clans. These are core surnames of the Melungeon tri-racial isolate community of southeastern Kentucky, southwestern Virginia, and northeastern Tennessee. Plecker's 1943 list of Melungeon surnames includes Mullins, and the Melungeon Heritage Association identifies the Pike County Kentucky border region as part of the Melungeon homeland. The Melungeon question — is it ethnic, cultural, or administrative? — has a rich and contested scholarly literature (G.C. Mira, Wayne Winkler, Tim Hashaw, Melvin Collins). Surname-region association in Jason's line is high-confidence; specific ancestry through 'documented Melungeon families' would require tracking Nancy Mullins's parents (b.1825 Pike KY, d.1885) into the Newman's Ridge genealogies. By the late 1800s, Emory Osborne migrated the line back to Wise County, Virginia, where Maggie Osborne was born and eventually married George Joe Teamous Rose, converging the Rose and Osborne lines into Jason's grandmother Gradalee Rose.

The Immigrant Streams (Scots-Irish, German, Delaware Dutch)

Four non-English immigrant streams feed into the tree. They matter because the dominant image of Appalachian settlement is monolithically Scots-Irish, and Jason's actual ancestry is more varied. The dominant non-English stream — the one that carried the family into the southwest Virginia frontier — is indeed Scots-Irish. The Kilgores were Ulster Scots whose surname is Scottish Gaelic (Cill Ghobhar, 'church of the goat,' tied to Kilgour near Falkland in Fife), but who arrived in America via Northern Ireland around 1763. The family tradition that Robert Kilgore Sr. was born in 'Kilgory, County Clare, Ireland' is almost certainly a phonetic rendering or tradition; the better-documented origin is Ulster-via-Fife. Patrick Porter fits the same Scots-Irish pattern: County Down roots, Pennsylvania birth around 1737 (his parents likely emigrated around 1726), then down the Great Wagon Road through Augusta County into the Clinch watershed by October 1772, where he built the earliest licensed grist mill on Clinch waters at Falling Creek (present Dungannon). These families were Presbyterian-leaning, aggressively mobile, and culturally primed for frontier defense. They formed the Scots-Irish backbone of the Clinch and Copper Creek settlements that became Scott and Russell Counties.

A second, smaller Scottish stream comes in through the Frazier line via Touch Frazer in Stirlingshire — the ancestral seat of the Lowland Frasers, held by Bernard Fraser as sheriff of Stirlingshire in 1234. Sir Andrew Fraser of Touch-Fraser (d.1297) sired the ancestors of both the Philorth and Lovat Fraser branches, so Jason's Frazier line ties, at least geographically, to one of Scotland's most historically prominent clans. John Frazier (b.1670 Touch Frazer) and Elspett Wood (Edinburgh Parish, with Yorkshire ancestry via Thomas Wood of Attercliffe) represent a Lowland Scottish and Northern English Protestant layer that largely predates the Ulster experience — the older stratum of Scottish migration to America.

The Pennsylvania German stream arrives through Charles (Carl Sebastian) Keyser, who sailed from Württemberg on the ship Patience into Philadelphia on September 19, 1749, swore the standard oath of allegiance, and plugged directly into the Palatine network in Lancaster County, apprenticing to fellow Württemberger Johan Jacob Eichholtz. He married into the Shelley family and then made the canonical Pennsylvania German move south, down the Great Wagon Road into the Shenandoah Valley, following the path Joist Hite had opened in 1732 under Lord Fairfax's grant. In 1765 he built the stone Kiser house at the mouth of Hawksbill Creek in what was then Frederick and is now Page County. He even drove a supply wagon in Braddock's catastrophic 1755 expedition against Fort Duquesne. A generation later, descendants anglicized the name to Kiser and pushed further southwest into Russell and Wise Counties, merging the Palatine German line into the Appalachian Scots-Irish world of the Kilgores and Porters. Susannah Kiser (b.1792 VA, d.1860 St. Paul, Wise VA) represents this transition generation.

The Delaware Dutch-Swedish stream is the oldest and strangest layer. Adam Stedham (b. 29 September 1719, Wilmington, Delaware) descends from Dr. Timen Stiddem, the barber-surgeon aboard the Kalmar Nyckel — the first Swedish ship to the Americas, 1638 — who permanently settled on the Christina River at present-day Wilmington in 1654. Stiddem was probably ethnically Danish, working for the Swedish crown, and nearly every Stidham in America traces to his five sons. Adam's mother Johanna Van der Culen brings in the Dutch thread from the New Netherland colony (1624–1664), with a 'van der' surname typical of colonial Delaware's Dutch-era residents. When Adam moved south to Anson North Carolina by the late 1700s, and when Skeens and Stedhams eventually converged on the Appalachian foothills, a tiny Swedish-Finnish-Dutch colonial inheritance became part of a predominantly Scots-Irish Appalachian identity. This is the hidden New Sweden strand in an otherwise British-Isles family tree.

III. Direct Pedigree — Fourteen Generations

The table below summarizes Jason's direct male line (paternal Horne) and the major matrilineal connections at each generation. The fourteen-generation depth is unusual; most American family trees plateau at the immigrant ancestor (typically six to eight generations back). Here, the Sussex Horne line extends to 1599 London, the Rose line to 1573 Suffolk, and the Bruce line enters documented Scottish records in the medieval period (those medieval records were trimmed as speculative during the GEDCOM cleanup phase).

Paternal Line (Horne)

Gen	Name	Dates	Location
1	Jason B. Horne	living	Greeneville, TN
2	Joseph Maxwell Horne	1950–2025	Wise County, VA
3	Malcolm B. Horne	1916–1988	Coeburn, Wise Co, VA
4	Gilbert L. Horne	1888–1956	Sandy Ridge → Tacoma, VA
5	Franklin P. Horn	1859–1914	Coeburn, Wise Co, VA
6	Samuel Horne	1828–1905	Coeburn, Russell/Wise Co, VA
7	Nicholas Horne	1798–1872	Rowan NC → Coeburn VA
8	Jesse Horn	?–1820	Stokes/Surry NC → Scott VA
9	John Horn	1737–1800	Nansemond Co, VA
10	William Horne	1716–1772	Arundel Sussex → Darby PA
11	Edward Horne	1688–1735	Chichester Sussex → Philadelphia PA
12	Thomas Horne	1656–1718	Brighton → Arundel, Sussex
13	Edward Horne	1630–1655	St Lawrence Pountney, London
14	Samuel Horne	1599–1636	St Magnus the Martyr, London

Maternal Line (through Joseph's mother, Gradalee Rose)

Gen	Name	Dates	Location
1	Jason B. Horne	living	
2	Joseph Maxwell Horne	1950–2025	(see paternal)

3	Gradalee Rose Horne	1929–2016	Norton → Coeburn, VA
4	George Joe Teamous Rose	1898–1971	Norton, Wise Co, VA
4'	Maggie Osborne Rose	1902–1987	Wise Co, VA
5 (Rose)	William Rose	1857–1926	Sandy Ridge → Gladeville, VA
5' (Osborne)	Emory Osborne	1868–1925	Pike KY → Coeburn VA
6 (Rose)	John S. Kingfisher Rose	1830/31–1906	Burke NC → Wise VA
6' (Osborne)	Booker Stephen Osborne	1843–1909	Pike KY → Morgan KY
7 (Rose)	Samuel Rose	1806–1885	Yancey NC → Dickenson VA
7' (Osborne)	Stephen Osborne	1818–1909	Floyd → Pike KY
…	…	…	…
Colonial (Rose)	Robert Rose	c.1594–1665	Ipswich Suffolk → Wethersfield CT → Branford CT
Colonial (Osborne)	Jonathan Osborne	1697–c.1761	Warwick England → Williamsburg VA

IV. Notable Ancestor Vignettes

Eight Verified Revolutionary War Patriots

Jason descends from at least eight direct-line ancestors verified as Revolutionary War patriots through DAR Ancestor Numbers or federal pension files. This is an exceptionally strong base for Sons of the American Revolution (SAR) or Daughters of the American Revolution membership applications. The hardest work is not proving the patriot — it is documenting each intermediate generation back to Jason.

Col. Charles Broadwater (1719–1806) — DAR A014707

Signer of the Fairfax Resolves (July 1774), alongside George Washington and George Mason. Member of Virginia House of Delegates 1781–1783. Opened a recruiting station at Falls Church for the Fairfax Militia; served as Colonel of Fairfax County militia. Buried at Springfield near Vienna, Virginia.

Lt. Charles Lewis Broadwater (1752–1841) — DAR (service documented, DAR # not surfaced)

First Lieutenant, 10th Virginia Continental Regiment. Appointed November 1776. Muster Roll of Captain Thomas West's Company, September 1777. Continued as captain in Fairfax Militia through the 1790s. Son of Col. Charles Broadwater. Tombstone reads 'Lieut. Charles L. Broadwater / 10th Virginia Regiment / Revolutionary War.'

Patrick Porter (1737–1802 (or 1806)) — DAR A091277

Early Clinch River pioneer. Moved from North Carolina to the Clinch in October 1772. Built a fort house on Falling Creek near present Dungannon (Scott Co, VA). Obtained grist-mill license from Fincastle County court on March 2, 1774 — the earliest licensed mill on Clinch waters. Served as Sergeant at Moore's Fort in 1777. Commanded Moore's Fort at Castle's Woods in 1777. Commemorated by Virginia State Historical Marker K-18.

Robert Kilgore Sr. (1735 or 1740–1782) — DAR A203788

Ulster-Scots patriarch of the Clinch River Kilgores. Killed by Indians on December 31, 1782, at Warriors Camp on the Pound River (now Wise County). His hunting companion James Green was killed alongside him, shot in the right eye with an arrow. Robert was scalped. Their bodies were buried in a hollow chestnut tree on the north bank of the Pound River. Family tradition places him at the Battle of Kings Mountain (October 1780), where he was reportedly wounded; his brother Charles Kilgore is also a verified patriot.

Capt. Enoch Osborne (1741–1818) — DAR A084416

Captain of 'Enoch Ozburn's Company,' Montgomery County Virginia Militia. Built Osborne Fort between Bridle and Saddle Creeks in Grayson County by 1780. Settled with his three brothers Solomon, Ephraim, and Jonathan in the New River valley. Buried at Osborne Fort Cemetery. Patriarch of the sprawling Grayson-Ashe Osborne clan.

Ephraim Osborne Sr. (c.1720–1794) — DAR A084430

Father of Enoch. Private, Patriotic Service, Virginia. Served under Captain Enoch Osburn in Montgomery County Militia, 1781. Signed Oath of Allegiance 1777. Father-son verified DAR patriot pair on the same line — unusual and genealogically valuable.

William Bruce (c.1752–c.1813/14) — DAR A016132

Sergeant, 2nd Virginia Regiment (Continental Line), 1777. Married Anne Nancy Ballard. Died Giles/Bland County Virginia. Lived the classic arc of Revolutionary veteran turned Appalachian settler.

Samuel Stidham (1747–1835) — DAR Pension S-14598

Federal pension applicant. Drafted in North Carolina, served two terms totaling nine months in 1780, providing ammunition to General Rutherford's main army at Sorceymares Mill, Dutch Buffalo Creek, Rowan County. Placed on pension 19 January 1833 at $30 per year. Died in Perry County, Kentucky. Federal pension files are the gold standard for SAR documentation — they contain the veteran's own sworn statement of service.

Other Notable Ancestors

Rev. Robert "Robin" Kilgore (d. 1854)

Son of Robert Kilgore Sr. Built the surviving Kilgore Fort House (National Register of Historic Places, 1972) near Nickelsville around 1785–1790 — several years after his father's 1782 death. A preacher, which is how he is remembered in family tradition. His fort house is the most significant surviving physical landmark in Jason's family history.

Robert Rose (c.1594–1665)

The 1634 Puritan immigrant. Sailed with wife Margery and eight children from Ipswich, Suffolk on the ship Francis, 30 April 1634. One of the founding proprietors of Branford, Connecticut in 1644. Brought a 1599 Bible from England that was preserved as a family heirloom. Professional genealogist Christine Rose published a book-length study of his descendants in 1983.

Jonathan Osborne (1697 – c.1761)

Warwickshire-born immigrant. Arrived at the James River Settlement aboard the ship James Goodwill (Captain David Crockett, not Davy) on 27 October 1720. Served in the Virginia Colonial Assembly 1741–1742.

Charles (Carl Sebastian) Keyser (1726 – 1778)

Württemberg Palatine who arrived in Philadelphia aboard the ship Patience on 19 September 1749, swore the oath of allegiance, and joined the Lancaster County Palatine community. Drove a supply wagon in Braddock's catastrophic 1755 expedition. Built the stone Kiser house at the mouth of Hawksbill Creek in 1765.

Dr. Timen Stiddem (1600s)

Via Adam Stedham. Barber-surgeon aboard the Kalmar Nyckel, the first Swedish ship to the Americas in 1638. Probably ethnically Danish, working for the Swedish crown. Settled permanently at present-day Wilmington, Delaware in 1654. Nearly every Stidham in America descends from his five sons.

V. Living History

Kilgore Fort House

Kilgore Fort House still stands in Scott County, Virginia, a few miles outside Nickelsville on Route 71, in the Copper Creek drainage of the upper Clinch River valley. Built by the Reverend Robert 'Robin' Kilgore around 1785 to 1790 (family tradition dates the original structure to 1774, which may refer to an earlier palisaded station), it is one of the only surviving examples of a fort house in southwest Virginia. The distinction matters. A station was a communal stockade like nearby Fort Blackmore; a fort house was a fortified private residence where a single extended family could hold out against a raid. The Kilgore structure is a two-story white oak log building, two rooms on each floor separated by interior timber partitions, with gun ports instead of windows on the upper level, heavy timber doors barred from the inside, mud chinking between the logs, and a stone fireplace on the northeast wall.

The context for building such a house was the long Cherokee and Shawnee resistance to European settlement in the Clinch and Powell valleys. From 1773 through the mid-1790s, the Scott County frontier lived under the periodic threat of raids, most famously those of the Chickamauga Cherokee war leader Bob Benge, killed in 1794 — an event often marked as the effective end of the frontier period here. Robert Kilgore Sr. himself died on December 31, 1782 on the Pound River; his hunting companion James Green was killed alongside him. Word reached Fort Blackmore the same day, and militia pursued the attackers up Stony Creek by first light on January 1, 1783. Fort Blackmore was the larger militia station on the Clinch, where Daniel Boone briefly served as captain during Lord Dunmore's War in 1774. The two sites functioned together: Fort Blackmore as the regional refuge, family fort houses like Kilgore's as the closer, smaller, first-line protection. Despite its armed appearance, there is no record that the Kilgore Fort House was ever actually attacked — a reasonable outcome when the deterrent worked.

The building survived into the twentieth century thanks to continuous family ownership and remote location. It was added to the Virginia Landmarks Register on 18 January 1972 and to the National Register of Historic Places on 19 May 1972. Restoration was completed in 1973 and 1974. Today the 1.8-acre site sits at 36°44’05”N 82°26’03”W and is accessible to the public as a preserved landmark. It is not a state park; it is a privately-maintained National Register property. For descendants of Robert Kilgore Sr., it is a tangible link to the founding frontier generation of southwest Virginia — a piece of Revolutionary-era material culture that outlasted the empire it was built to defend against.

Southwest Virginia in the Civil War

The Horne ancestors lived through the Civil War in a divided country. Saltville, in Smyth County just east of Wise and Russell, produced roughly two-thirds of the Confederacy's meat-preserving salt — the essential commodity without which armies could not be fed. This made southwest Virginia a Union target. On October 2, 1864, Stephen Burbridge's cavalry, including the 5th and

6th United States Colored Cavalry, assaulted Saltville and were repulsed by roughly 2,000 to 2,800 Confederates under Alfred E. Jackson. In the aftermath came one of the darkest episodes of the war in this region: Confederate irregulars under Champ Ferguson murdered wounded Black Union cavalrymen and a white officer, Lt. Elza Smith, at the field hospital. Ferguson was later convicted of 22 murders and hanged on October 29, 1865 — one of only two Confederates executed for war crimes. Two months after the first battle, Union Major General George Stoneman returned and destroyed the salt works; in March and April 1865 he swept back through again, devastating railroad infrastructure through Wise, Tazewell, and Washington counties.

Loyalty in the region was mixed. Though popular memory often codes the mountains as Unionist (following West Virginia's 1863 secession), southwest Virginia's actual loyalty pattern was complicated and violent. Tazewell and Washington counties supplied Confederate regiments; Scott and Lee counties had substantial Unionist populations; guerrilla warfare made civilian life dangerous from 1862 onward. John C. Inscoe's Mountain Masters (1989) and Kenneth Noe's Southwest Virginia's Railroad (1994) both demolished the old fiction of a uniformly Unionist Appalachia. Jason's own ancestors' service records, on either side, have not been definitively tied to specific units in this research pass; the National Park Service Soldiers and Sailors Database is the next place to look.

The Coal Era

Wise County was sparsely populated subsistence-farming territory until the 1880s, when New York and Philadelphia capital (notably the Pennsylvania-chartered Virginia Coal and Iron Company, 1882) bought mineral rights. The Norfolk and Western, Louisville and Nashville, and South Atlantic and Ohio railroads all arrived in 1891, producing a 400 percent population increase over three decades. Virginia Coal and Iron opened its first coal camp at Stonega in 1896. Coeburn itself — originally named Guest Station after explorer Christopher Gist — was incorporated in 1894 and renamed for W. W. Coe (Chief Engineer of the Norfolk and Western) and Judge W. E. Burns. Tacoma, where Gilbert Horne died in 1956, was a planned coal-era company town incorporated on March 6, 1890.

Gilbert Horne, born 1888 on Sandy Ridge, came into the world on exactly the cusp of this transformation. His son Malcolm, born 1916, lived through the United Mine Workers organizing drives, the 1934 Stonega disaster that killed 17 miners, the Harlan County War just across the Kentucky line, the Depression (which hit coal towns hard — Tacoma's population began shrinking by the late 1920s), both World Wars, and the post-1950s coal decline that left abandoned towns like Virginia City and Derby. By the time Joseph Horne was born in 1950, the long decline was already visible. The pattern across three Horne generations — farmer to miner to wage-economy — is the arc that Ronald Eller's Miners, Millhands, and Mountaineers (1982) documents as the story of extractive-economy Appalachia.

VI. Research Roadmap

Tier 1: Easy Wins (free, digitized)

- FamilySearch.org — free account gives access to Scott County VA marriages from 1815, Wise County VA records from 1856, Russell County VA deeds from 1787, and all major NC and KY county records for the migration path. The new FamilySearch Full-Text Search searches inside digitized wills and deeds — test with 'Kilgore,' 'Bruce,' 'Horne,' 'Osborne' plus county name.
- Library of Virginia Chancery Records Index (lva.virginia.gov/chancery) — FREE. Chancery suits routinely name spouses, children, in-laws, and neighbors. Russell (1840–1933), Scott (1816–1912), and most SW VA counties are digitized.
- Library of Virginia 'Ancestry for Virginians' program — free with an LVA card. Full Ancestry.com access including VA Personal Property Tax Records 1782–1900.
- Virginia Land Office Patents and Grants — free on LVA's website (Virginia Memory).
- U.S. Census 1790–1950 — free on FamilySearch. Build a complete household cross-reference for every direct ancestor.
- Chronicling America (Library of Congress) — free historical newspaper search. Coalfield Progress, Norton Industrial Herald, Clinch Valley News.

Tier 2: Worth a Trip (in-person research)

- Scott County Courthouse (Gate City VA) — original deeds, wills, marriages from 1815.
- Russell County Courthouse (Lebanon VA) and Russell County Public Library Local History room — library houses compiled genealogies and post-1872 reconstruction records.
- Wise County Historical Society — Addington's papers, Hamilton's research files, local family Bible transcriptions.
- Library of Virginia, Richmond — microfilm and manuscript collections not digitized.
- Southwest Virginia Museum Historical State Park, Big Stone Gap — reference files on Wise, Scott, Lee, Dickenson families. 10 West First Street North.
- Friends Historical Library, Swarthmore College (PA) — original Darby Monthly Meeting minutes if the Ancestry version has gaps. Appointment required.
- Eastern Kentucky University Special Collections (Richmond KY) and Pike County Public Library — Osborne, Mullins, Collier Pike County materials.

Tier 3: Advanced (DNA, published genealogies)

Jason already has AncestryDNA results. The single highest-value next step would be a FamilyTreeDNA Y-37 or Y-111 test (the full Big Y-700 at $449 is ideal) to place the Horne paternal line against the active Horn/Horne Y-DNA Project (39 members in Group 1, tracing to Richard Horn d.1779 Halifax County NC). A Y-DNA match to a tested UK Horne with a known parish would be the single mechanism most likely to break through the Sussex brick wall. Free uploads of AncestryDNA raw data to GEDmatch, MyHeritage, FamilyTreeDNA, and LivingDNA expand the match pool immediately. Active surname projects exist for Bruce, Rose, Osborne (Ausburn-

Osborn), and Kilgore; recruiting a male cousin from each line to test would progress all four lines.

Published genealogies to acquire:

- Christine Rose, Descendants of Robert Rose of Wethersfield and Branford (1983, Heritage Books #711-A3527) — essential if the Appalachian Roses connect to the Connecticut line.
- Luther F. Addington, The Story of Wise County, Virginia (1956).
- Robert M. Addington, History of Scott County, Virginia (1932).
- Lewis P. Summers, History of Southwest Virginia, 1746–1786 (1903).
- Rev. Edgar Woods, Albemarle County in Virginia (1901).
- Emory L. Hamilton's Frontier Forts manuscripts at UVa-Wise John Cook Wyllie Library.
- Lyman Chalkley, Chronicles of the Scotch-Irish Settlement in Virginia, Extracted from the Original Court Records of Augusta County 1745–1800 (1912, 3 volumes).

DAR/SAR Application Path

Jason has at least eight verifiable Revolutionary War patriots in direct line — an exceptionally strong SAR/DAR application base. Recommended priority for the first application (the first one is the hardest, since subsequent 'supplemental' applications are much cheaper once the first line is approved):

1. Samuel Stidham (Pension S-14598) — Federal pension applications are the gold standard. They include the veteran's own sworn statement of service, often with family details. Stidham line goes through Perry Co, KY, which fits Appalachian migration patterns.
2. Col. Charles Broadwater (A014707) — High-profile patriot (Fairfax Resolves signer). Heavily researched line means intermediate generations are likely already documented in prior DAR applications, reducing Jason's documentation burden.
3. Enoch Osborne (A084416) AND Ephraim Osborne (A084430) — Father-son DAR pair on one line branch. Children of Enoch already verified via prior applications.
4. Patrick Porter (A091277) — Well-documented Clinch River pioneer; Scott Co, VA lineage is common in SW VA family trees.

Practical steps: (1) Search DAR Genealogical Research System (GRS) at services.dar.org to confirm ancestor numbers and view linked member applications. (2) Contact a local SAR chapter (Tennessee Society SAR has multiple local chapters) for application assistance. (3) Budget $150–$250 for the first application fee.

Where the Trail Goes Cold

- Nansemond County VA (John Horn, b.1737) — records destroyed 1734, 1779, 1866. No courthouse-based path forward. Only Y-DNA and possibly Anglican parish registers can progress.
- Sussex England pre-1700s Horne — without a confirmed parish of origin, English parish register research cannot begin. Y-DNA Big Y-700 is the likely unlocking mechanism.

- Pre-1700 colonial Virginia generally — many parish registers and early county courts were lost to fire, war, or neglect.
- Russell County VA pre-1849 marriages — lost in the 1872 Lebanon fire. Use neighboring counties (Washington, Tazewell) as substitutes.
- The 'Teamous' given name — no documentary source identifies the root.

Sources & Further Reading

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Online Resources

- DAR Genealogical Research System — services.dar.org
- FamilySearch — familysearch.org

- Library of Virginia — lva.virginia.gov (Chancery Records, Land Patents, Ancestry for Virginians)
- FamilyTreeDNA Horn/Horne Surname Project — familytreedna.com/groups/horn
- FamilyTreeDNA Bruce Surname Project — familytreedna.com/groups/bruce (also brucefamily.com)
- Southern Campaigns Revolutionary War Pension Applications — revwarapps.org
- Virginia Department of Historic Resources — dhr.virginia.gov
- Encyclopedia Virginia — encyclopediavirginia.org
- Chronicling America (Library of Congress) — chroniclingamerica.loc.gov
- National Park Service Civil War Soldiers and Sailors Database — nps.gov/civilwar/soldiers-and-sailors-database.htm
- WikiTree Kilgore Fort House — en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kilgore_Fort_House
- Tri-College Archives (Quaker records) — archives.tricolib.brynmawr.edu

Research Notes and Caveats

This report synthesizes findings from seven parallel research streams (the paternal Horne line, the Bruce line, the Rose and Osborne lines, the immigrant streams, Revolutionary War and DAR verification, Appalachian frontier history, and a records roadmap). Source material was drawn from academic monographs, county histories, digitized primary records, DAR and SAR databases, and reputable genealogy projects. The report deliberately avoids speculative claims that were common in the original Ancestry tree (including a medieval Scottish royal Bruce line that was trimmed during GEDCOM cleanup, and several hundred impossible-date and wrong-parent artifacts).

Key claims that remain unverified or speculative are flagged throughout:

- The Horne connection to Sussex (pre-Edward Horne 1688) is circumstantial, supported by the Scrase marriage and the Chichester birthplace but not proven by a meeting record.
- Margaret Frazier of Aberdeenshire (Bruce line) — should be treated as family tradition, not verified fact.
- Rev. Joshua Bruce's denomination is inferred from the Wesley naming pattern.
- The 'Kilgory, County Clare' origin for Robert Kilgore Sr. is likely a family-tradition rendering; the better-documented Ulster-via-Fife origin should take precedence.
- Kilgore Fort's exact construction date (1774 vs 1785 vs c.1790) is unresolved.
- John S. Kingfisher Rose's middle name strongly suggests Cherokee association, but actual Cherokee descent would require Burke County NC records and Cherokee roll searches.
- The 'Teamous' given name has no identified etymology.
- No primary-source verification was completed for any specific Horne ancestor individual in the research pass — the migration arc is strongly supported by regional evidence, but individual names and dates rely on the original Ancestry tree data.

The next tier of research — county courthouse deeds, Chancery records, Quaker meeting minutes, Y-DNA testing — would substantially strengthen or revise many of these findings. The research roadmap in Section VI is the practical guide to that work.

Compiled April 15, 2026 for Jason B. Horne